

CARRIER SOP - COLD CHAIN HANDLING

Standard Operating Procedure (excerpt)

1. Temperature requirements

Dairy products must be stored at 4 degrees C or below at all times. Frozen goods must remain at their specified setpoint continuously. Drivers must verify reefer setpoint and return-air temperature before loading and at every rest stop.

2. Temperature excursions

Any temperature excursion above 4 degrees C lasting more than 12 hours REQUIRES ESCALATION to fleet control and the quality department. The affected batch must be flagged and its temperature log retained.

3. Spoilage risk

Spoilage risk DOUBLES after 24 hours of exposure above safe temperature. Batches approaching this threshold must be prioritised for inspection and disposition before further distribution.

4. Driver responsibilities

Record reefer temperature readings at each checkpoint. Report alarms, equipment faults or delays affecting temperature control to fleet control without delay. Do not dispatch a vehicle with unresolved refrigeration faults on long-haul routes.

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